

Points to ponder...

Dear Sumod,

I have three points to make:

1. Set aside economics for a moment, and there's just one reason why the general user prefers Windows over Linux—'familiarity'. While we might consider having Linux as the 'second' OS, a central shift to Linux is unlikely anytime soon. I suggest you have a column dedicated to it in Digit. After all, in real life, as in technology, familiarity is pretty much everything when it comes to mass acceptance and usage.
2. You've given imaging tips on Paint Shop Pro, Illustrator and Photoshop, but missed out on Ulead PhotoImpact 8, which, in my opinion, far exceeds the capabilities of Paint Shop Pro, and even gives Photoshop a run for its money. This software has never been featured, even in past reviews. You even included a PhotoImpact demo, in a recent issue, but ignored its potential—I say this as a long-term PhotoImpact user with a legal and registered license.
3. The August issue of Digit was being sold by 'agents' at CST station, Mumbai, on August 1 itself, and that too for only 50 bucks. As a subscriber, I got the same issue late the next day, and I think I pay a little more than that. Amusing, but true!

Natraj Jayaraman

Via e-mail



Suse Distro

Dear Sumod,

I am a subscriber of Digit, and await the arrival of your magazine eagerly every month. When I read the July issue, I was pretty excited to read about the August 2003 Linux DVD special. Unfortunately, I felt let down by the contents of the DVD. Though you did distribute popular Linux distros, including RedHat and Mandrake, I was shocked to see that you didn't include SuSE. This, after you adjudged SuSE to be the best Linux distribution in an earlier edition.

Vicky Jambhore

Via e-mail

Dear Vicky,

The reason why we have not been able to carry SuSE, despite our wish to do so, underlines the shift in the Linux marketplace to profiting from distribution. Until a couple of years ago, you could freely download and distribute any Linux distribution, and would only have to pay for it if you wanted support. Now, vendors are expecting to make money from the sale of copies of their distribution, much like any other paid software. SuSE and some other vendors declined to share their distribution for free on these grounds. If you want SuSE distributions, you will have to pay for them.

Dear Natraj,

We agree with your observation on Linux usage, and we do accordingly have a regular workshop showing how to perform everyday tasks in Linux, called Linux Works.

As for the Rs. 50 early edition at Mumbai CST station, the source is quite obvious. Mumbai CST is where we load our copies for distribution around the country every month. During this loading process, some bundles inevitably 'fall off' the trains, with some helping hands of course. These 'fallen' copies are the ones you see peddled at CST the day before you, and most of our country, get to see them. Just another fact of life that our distribution team has learned the hard way.

Graphics Drivers on CD

Hi Digit,

I may not be the first one to notice it, but you manage to include the same old versions of Windows Media Player, DirectX, Winzip, Acrobat Reader, etc., in the essentials section of the Mindware CD every month. I think you should do the same with your Playware CD by creating a section that will include the latest Detonator, Catalyst, audio, or video drivers. With nVidia promising a 30 per cent performance increase with the latest drivers, consider this as a gamer's plea for more FPS.

Saurabh Majumdar

Via e-mail

Hi Saurabh,

That's a great suggestion! However, there is little point in carrying these drivers every month. We will ensure that our readers have access to such critical drivers, as well as motherboard drivers from Via and Intel, as and when they are updated.

Goof Ups

■ Kaushal Pai has pointed out that 'Learn how to Install and uninstall Linux the easy way', should have pointed to page 92, instead of page 62, as said on the index page.

■ An unfortunate design error caused the capacity and spindle speed values on the hard disk tables to shift down, on pages 60 and 61.

Notice any goof-ups?

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